



Closeout Report

PROJECT RESULTS & OUTCOMES - FUND 11

Project Catalyst Fund 11

Milestone 5 - Finalization

Reporting period: 2024-02-29 to 2026-09-29

Issued: September 29, 2026

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1 • Executive Summary

Sync.Land set out to give independent artists a way to license their music for sync, meaning film, games, podcasts and streams, without a publisher, a catalogue deal or a gatekeeper, and to record each licence on Cardano so that both sides hold durable proof of the transaction.

That platform exists and is live at <https://www.sync.land>. At closeout it carries **660 published songs from 93 artist profiles in 26 countries** (read on 29 September; the close-out video, recorded three hours earlier, shows the homepage at 653 tracks and 85 artists in 26 countries, counting only the profiles that name a country, as section 5.1 explains), with a working licensing flow, Stripe payments in production, on-chain CIP-25 receipts, a public REST API, a briefs-and-pitches board, and an open-source OBS player that streamers can run over the catalogue, with a one-page setup at sync.land/stream rebuilt in the final week around the first outside streamer to install it. Since 27 September the free licence covers live streams, and the player licenses every track it plays to the streamer on its first play. Every milestone artefact from M1 through M4 is published in this repository.

The honest headline is that the supply side works and the demand side is early. Artists arrive unprompted, register, upload and stay: September brought 95 organic signups by the evening of the 29th, 48 of them referred by a language model rather than a search engine, and 258 published songs, more than twice the 116-song catalogue import that seeded the site in March. Buyers are not yet arriving at the same rate. **Fourteen licences have been issued to date**, none of them bought by a third party who found the site on their own, and in the thirty days to the date of issue no outside buyer paid for a licence. The infrastructure a marketplace needs is built and proven; the marketplace itself is at the start of its life, not the end.

Much of the final fortnight went on the question a music marketplace cannot avoid in 2026: what to do about generated audio. The answer shipped in three parts. A policy, adopted on 8 September, that fully generated audio is not licensed because it has no copyright owner; a disclosure that every artist now makes at upload and that buyers now see on every catalogue row, album and song page; and a provenance check, live from 18 September, that reads what the uploaded file says about itself and puts the small number of files that name a generator in front of a person, never in front of the public. A model score now runs on every upload as well, as a prompt to listen and never as a verdict. The research behind it, including what does not work, is published alongside this report.

The last days before issue went on the platform's second audience, streamers. Version 1.2 of the Free Sync License (27 September) names a live stream through the Sync.Land player as a permitted use, treats each broadcast as its own project with no twelve-month term, and makes the on-screen credit the attribution. The player now licenses each track on its first play and offers only the tracks that licence covers. Three short promotional videos, one each for game developers, filmmakers and streamers, were scored from the catalogue under the same licence, with the credit on screen.

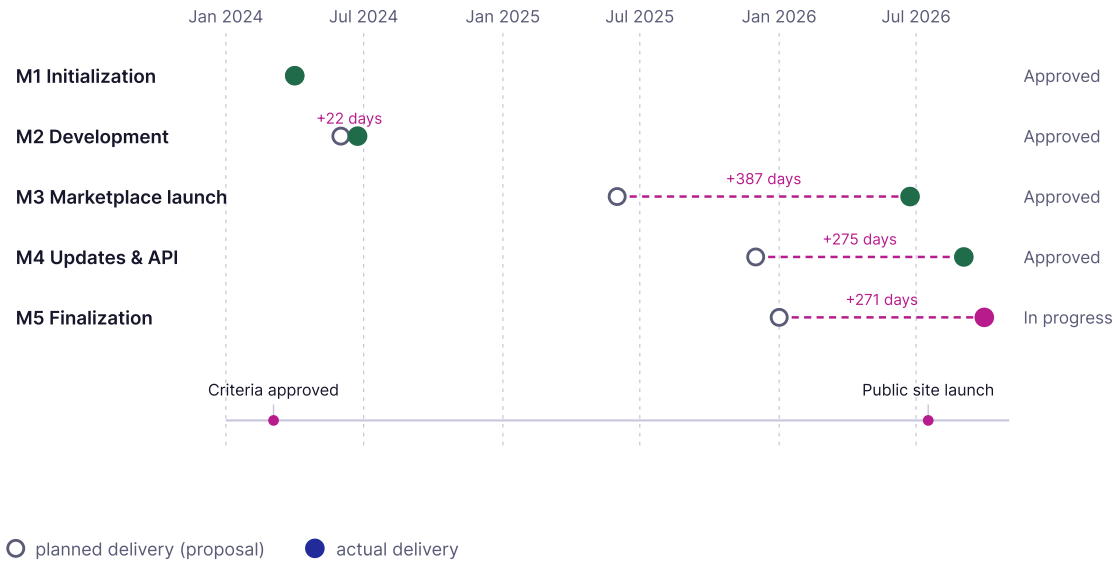
This report documents what was promised against what shipped, the full feature inventory, the final architecture, production metrics read on the date of issue, what was learned, including the things that went wrong, and what continues after Fund 11.

2 · Goals versus Outcomes

Each row states what the funded proposal promised and what actually shipped. Where the two differ, the difference is stated plainly rather than reframed.

#	MILESTONE	PROMISED	DELIVERED	STATUS
M1	Initialization	Design document, agile board, infrastructure (NMKR + CardanoPress), GitHub repository	All four. Design report, project status and timeline published in docs/M1_Initialization/	Approved
M2	Development	Marketplace architecture, pilot user selection, song upload, first sync-licence NFT transaction	All four, with two screen-recorded test cases: user registration and song upload, and a Cardano NFT transaction carrying sync-licence metadata	Approved
M3	Marketplace Launch & API Development	Public launch, marketplace API proof of concept, launch surveys, repository update	Public site launched, API proof of concept, on-chain evidence and user feedback reports, NFT licence purchase test case	Approved
M4	Marketplace Updates & API Launch	User feedback gathered and analysed, marketplace updates and bug fixes, public API module, updated documentation	Seven PDFs, OpenAPI spec v1.2.0, public licence verifier, OBS player v0.2.0 under Apache 2.0, external-application test case recording	Approved 2026-09-10
M5	Finalization	Closeout report and video, final tasks and bug fixes, results documentation	This report, the evidence index and the accompanying video	This submission

Fund 11 delivery: planned against actual



M1 and M2 landed on plan. The three later milestones slipped, and the gap is drawn to scale rather than described. Section 6 covers what the additional time was spent on.

Fund 11 delivery, planned against actual

M1 and M2 landed on schedule. The three later milestones did not, and the timeline draws the slip to scale rather than describing it. Section 6 covers what the additional time was spent on.

2.1 Where outcomes diverged from the proposal

Five divergences are worth stating directly, because each one changed the product and each was discovered by shipping rather than by planning.

THE PROPOSAL ASSUMED	WHAT SHIPPING SHOWED	WHAT THE PRODUCT DOES NOW
The on-chain licence receipt would serve as proof of licence.	No distribution platform, not YouTube, not Meta, not TikTok, accepts a third-party token as evidence of clearance; their rights systems require an exclusivity claim that a non-exclusive sync licence cannot carry.	The receipt stays in the product as tamper-evident proof of <i>when</i> a licence was issued and on what terms. The site copy no longer describes it as anything more.
CC-BY would be the free tier.	CC-BY gives away more than an artist offering music for sync intends, and cannot be withdrawn.	Replaced on 2026-07-11 by the Sync.Land Free Sync License (SLFS-v1), written for this use, with no database migration because no existing licence changed meaning.
Three licensing tiers would be purchasable.	The third had no completed purchase path. An artist read the tiers, found the one he wanted unavailable, and declined to upload his catalogue.	The custom tier for reserved uses is described by SLCS-v1.0 (2026-09-10) as something an artist is asked about rather than sold by default. The proposed fix, a Custom opt-in at upload and a request flow for buyers, is section 7 item 4 and is not built.

THE PROPOSAL ASSUMED	WHAT SHIPPING SHOWED	WHAT THE PRODUCT DOES NOW
Buyers and artists would arrive together.	48 of the 50 accounts created between June and mid-September are musicians. Every licence issued since the marketplace relaunched was issued to the project itself: tests, demonstrations and its own promotional videos.	The platform is a working supply-side product waiting for its demand side. Section 7 is written from that position rather than around it.
Delivery would complete in month 22 (January 2026).	Closeout is 29 September 2026, 271 days later.	Section 6 records what the additional time was spent on.

3 • Features Delivered

Full inventory across M1 to M5.

3.1 Artist onboarding

Self-serve registration with role selection, artist profile creation, and a four-step album upload wizard (album details, licensing terms, songs, review).

Uploads accept lossless masters. The wizard generates the streaming MP3 and the 200-point waveform in the browser at upload time, so a track is playable the moment it is published. Metadata capture covers the fields a buyer actually checks before licensing: ISRC, IPI, PRO affiliation, master and publishing splits, one-stop clearance, samples status, and an AI-use disclosure.

Artists can edit their own catalogue after publication, pausing a track, removing it, or correcting its metadata and pricing, through owner-scoped REST endpoints and a pencil-edit control on the dashboard.

Since 2026-09-11 every uploaded audio file is checked before it goes live. The worker probes each file for the failures real uploads have produced (a macOS sidecar instead of the WAV, an unreadable or empty file, silence, a track only seconds long), and a file that fails is held under a “file check” state, separate from the AI-material review, while the artist is told which file to pick. Artist and administrator notifications for the hold have been on since 12 September. The uploader also refuses `.*` sidecar files outright. The backfill over the 458 songs published when the check shipped flagged the one file already known to be bad and nothing else; by the date of issue 669 uploaded files had been checked and nothing is held.

Since 15 September the wizard names the field that is blocking a submission instead of returning silently to step one, and a restored draft that has lost its cover art lands on the step that needs it, with the reason. The image optimiser that had been taking two minutes to resize one artist’s cover art inside the request she was waiting on no longer runs there.

In the final week the wizard was shortened for an artist with a whole release. Rights, tags and PRO are asked once per release rather than once per track: one box confirms the artist owns the master and publishing with no uncleared samples, one copies the first track’s genre, mood and AI answer to the rest, and PRO and IPI are saved on the artist and filled in next time. The Content ID question appears only once a distributor is ticked, and two closing checkboxes became one. Filenames the storage host refused (an apostrophe, or any character outside plain ASCII such as a curly quote or an accent) are cleaned in the browser before upload, leaving the title the artist typed untouched, and a failed upload says what happened instead of a bare “Upload failed”. A release is

no longer lost when the connection drops at submit: the draft is kept until the server confirms the release exists, and since 29 September a copy is also kept on the artist's account, so it comes back on another browser or device; a ten-second reachability check runs before sending, and each submit attempt is recorded with its size and the connection's own figures, never the files themselves. An attempt that never arrived can now be told apart from one the server refused.

Signups that stall are followed up by hand, from templates. A command lists who registered and stopped before a profile or a first track, and drafts the note to them, in the founder's voice and from his own address, into a Drafts folder. Nothing sends until a person presses Send. The templates follow a written voice guide whose rules were extended in the final week: no comparisons or superlatives about the site, no revenue-split figure in artist mail for now, and the caution about generated material stated plainly.

3.2 Marketplace and discovery

Public catalogue with genre, mood and commercial filters; an artist directory with territory attribution and a flag for each profile; a persistent site-wide player with waveform scrubbing; per-song licensing pages; and a briefs board where music supervisors post requirements and artists pitch tracks against them.

Since 17 September a declared AI use is visible wherever a track is listed, not only on its own page: a small badge ("Partly AI-generated" or "AI-generated") sits with the genre and mood tags on catalogue rows, album track tables and the single-song view, with the artist's own declaration as its hover text; album cards on artist pages carry the badge with a count when only some tracks declare ("3 of 8"); and the notice under the licence box on the song page is a bordered panel with the artist's own words about what the tool did. Undeclared and human-only tracks show nothing. The discovery API exposes the same field per row, so an external application sees what a buyer sees.

Every link to the site now previews as a branded card. Since 18 September a 1200 by 630 share card is rendered for each song, album, artist and brief (dark ground, wordmark, title, artist, genre and mood chips, the AI declaration where one exists, the cover art as a tile), with a portrait variant for Instagram; static pages share a fixed site card. Cards are regenerated when their inputs change, rendered lazily on first request, and swept hourly. On the date of issue 947 of the 949 published songs, albums, artists and briefs carried a card, one song and one album being without one at the moment of reading.

A help centre at `/help/` is now a searchable knowledge base, with a topic for streamers; the homepage keeps five questions and points to it for the rest. A legal footer row, with the Terms and the Privacy Policy, is on every page, including the player pages where no footer had rendered before.

Since 26 September the site is easier for search engines and assistants to read. Song pages carry corrected structured data (duration, ISRC, the licences a song actually offers with a price per tier, and the artist's AI declaration). `/llms.txt` and a longer `/llms-full.txt` are generated from live counts and the help centre. The sitemap drops pages that should not be indexed. The catalogue, genre and artist listings now carry plain links to every song and artist for crawlers that do not run scripts, where before they shipped empty containers filled in by JavaScript. And IndexNow is live, so new and changed pages are submitted to Bing and the other IndexNow engines within minutes: the first submission, the whole sitemap of 876 URLs, has been accepted, and 952 URLs in all by the date of issue.

3.3 Licensing

Two live licence paths. **SLFS-v1** is the free tier, purpose-written for sync use, with an auto-upgrade path when a licensee crosses the view cap. **Commercial** licensing runs through Stripe in production, issuing a licence PDF and minting a CIP-25 receipt on Cardano via NMKR. Each licence has a public verification endpoint that requires no credentials, and a human-readable certificate page at `/1/{id}`; the latter exists because CIP-25 caps on-chain metadata at 64 bytes per field, too small to carry licence terms directly.

On 2026-09-10 the commercial tier gained a document of its own, the Sync.Land Commercial Sync License (SLCS-v1.0). It reserves ten uses, among them broadcast television, theatrical release, advertising above a spend threshold, subscription originals, games above a revenue threshold, resale, endorsement and political use, AI training and exclusivity, that an artist should be asked about rather than sold by default, and each licence now snapshots the version it was issued under, so a certificate states what it covers. The custom tier for those reserved uses still has no purchase flow; section 7 returns to it.

On 27 September the free tier moved to **SLFS-v1.2**, which adds live streams through a Sync.Land player as a permitted use. Each broadcast, with its recording and clips, is one Project, so the 100,000-view cap applies per broadcast; live-stream use has no twelve-month term; and the player's on-screen credit is the attribution. Artists with music already on the site are asked to agree to the new version on their next visit, with a "Not now" that returns after a week, rather than by a mass email. By the date of issue 16 of the 67 artists with published music had agreed, not counting the project's own artist account, covering 110 songs (312 with the project's own catalogue), and the agreement is recorded with its version, time and address like any other Terms acceptance.

The project licensed its own marketing the same way. Three short promotional videos, one each for game developers, filmmakers and streamers, are each scored with a catalogue track licensed on Sync.Land under SLFS-v1.2 (licences 15351, 15352 and 15353), with the credit line on screen throughout. Each licence has a CIP-25 receipt submitted through NMKR on Cardano preprod; at the date of issue none of the three was yet on chain, so they are reported here as submitted, minting pending. The videos are drafts and have not yet been published. These three are the project's own licences and are not counted as third-party licensing in section 5.3.

The same approach has been carried to Valt, Awen's sister platform for music collectors: an independent artist from the catalogue signed a Valt Featured Artist Licence for a music video in September, through Awen's own document e-signing.

3.4 Public API and OBS player

A documented REST surface under `/wp-json/FML/v1/`, specified in `code/docs/api-spec.yaml` (v1.2.0) and covering catalogue reads, licence verification, and the streamer endpoints. Personal access tokens scope requests per user.

Built on it, the **Sync.Land OBS Player** (v0.2.0, Apache 2.0, separate repository) runs as an OBS Custom Browser Dock, letting a streamer play licensed music on-stream with an attribution overlay that updates per track. A demo mode serves a consent-gated playlist with no account required, so the dock can be tried before signing up.

The setup was rebuilt in the final week around the first outside streamer to install the player (section 5.7). One page, `sync.land/stream`, takes a streamer from signup to music on stream: it makes a player link with the access key built in, placed after the `#` so that it never reaches a server log; setup in OBS is two pastes, the player as a dock and the overlay as a source; and the page shows a live "Player connected" tick, read from the last time the key was used. The player itself now says "This link goes in OBS, not your browser" when it is opened in an ordinary browser, shows a status line inside OBS (connected or demo, overlay on or missing), and

covers itself with instructions if it is added as a source instead of a dock. Every surface uses the same three terms: player, overlay, your player link. The main menu has a “For Streamers” entry, the homepage a streamer band and the help centre a Streaming topic. A returning streamer gets a “Get my player link” button rather than being told they are already set up, and only streamers who are not also musicians are sent to `/stream` after signup. Streamers are the platform’s second acquisition funnel, after artists.

The Dock was then finished around one rule: every track it plays is licensed to the streamer on its first play. That creates one Free Sync License record per streamer and track, scoped to live streams under v1.2, and links it from the usage-ledger row for the play; before this, the ledger had recorded plays but no licence had ever been attached to one. Streamers can save any public playlist to their account and see it in the Dock, license a whole playlist in one step, and start from Sync.Land picks shown on `/stream`, so a new streamer has something to play in the first minute. On 29 September `/stream` gained a picture for each step, drawn in the OBS interface itself, showing the difference that tripped up the first streamer: the player is a dock only the streamer sees, the overlay a source the viewers see. What the Dock will play is decided by one gate, the same verdict the licence uses: published, not paused, not held for review or a file check, not fully generated, free tier offered, audio present. On the date of issue 546 of the 660 published songs passed it; of the other 114, 113 belong to releases whose artists have switched the free tier off and one is held until its artist says how it was made (section 3.6). The player’s clearance answer agreed with the licence verdict for all 660. The overlay now shows the release year beside the credit.

These pieces are days old and their use so far is small. By the date of issue three Sync.Land picks had been marked (Cinematic, Electronic and Around the World), and the only saved playlists belonged to the project’s own artist account. No outside streamer had played through the Dock since the change shipped on 27 September. The two stream licences on record were both issued on 29 September to the project’s own artist account, the day the close-out video was recorded; the path had first been verified on production with a test account that was then removed. Twenty-four player links have been made by fifteen accounts, and three accounts have connected a player in OBS, two of them the project’s own.

3.5 Trust, consent and audit

A versioned terms-acceptance gate records who accepted which version, when, and from where, with a SHA-256 snapshot of the document for tamper evidence, and an admin screen that exports the log as CSV. A usage ledger records each dock play with its clearance verdict. Clearance itself is modelled explicitly, as one-stop status, samples status and territory, rather than assumed.

Two policies were added in the final fortnight. On 2026-09-08 the Terms, the Free Sync License and the uploader adopted a single position on generated material: audio produced entirely by a generator is not published or licensed, because it has no copyright owner and therefore nothing to license, and audio made partly with a generator is accepted, labelled, and licensed for its human-made parts only. The help centre still described a stricter rule until 29 September, when its answers were rewritten to match the Terms; the help centre and FAQs are now updated in the same change as any change to the Terms or a licence. On 2026-09-10 an account-closure procedure was written into the Privacy Policy (section 9) and given a command (`wp syncland-account`) that removes the account and its unlicensed catalogue while keeping the licences it issued, the tracks under them (private, under a holding account) and its Terms record, so that a closed account cannot erase a licensee’s proof. The procedure has been used twice, on 11 and 23 September, each time at the account holder’s request and on the day it was asked for. Both closures were over the policy on generated material: one artist whose work was fully generated, and one who read the policy as excluding AI-assisted work as well. Section 5.7 tells the first story.

3.6 Provenance of uploaded audio

The disclosure in 3.1 is a warranty by the artist. What the platform can add to it is limited, and the limit was measured before anything shipped. A research note published with this report

([ai-music-detection-2026-09.md](#)) records the state of AI-music detection as of September 2026 as it applies to this catalogue: a pilot over 38 catalogue files found that none of the audio-statistics heuristics in circulation (spectral rolloff, energy above 18 kHz, stereo correlation, spectral peakiness) separates the declared-assisted tracks from studio masters uploaded the same week; the one open classifier worth trying was trained on generator versions two years old and is evaluated on paper only; and every commercial detector sends the artist's master off-site, which the Terms do not cover. The note also found that the strongest signal available was one the platform already downloaded and threw away: a generator's own stamp in the file's metadata.

Provenance v2, live from 18 September, acts on that finding. The transcode worker now reads every metadata chunk of every file it handles, including the chunks some DAWs write after the audio data and the RIFF comment field where one popular generator writes "made with suno". When a file itself names a generator, the site records it, and an administrator's Provenance Review page opens with a "Names a generator" table listing the tool, where it was found, and what the artist declared, with a one-click licensing hold through the existing disclosure review. Only files where the tool is named *and* the artist declared none or nothing appear there; a declared-assisted track that carries the stamp is consistent and is not listed. Nothing on any public page, in the clearance API, on the artist dashboard or in email changes. A person decides whether to ask; nothing is automatic.

The whole catalogue has now been re-read under v2: all 660 published songs. Seven files carry the Suno stamp. Six are declared AI-assisted, which is consistent. One, uploaded in July before the disclosure field existed, is undeclared and is the one file the review table lists for a human look; on 29 September it was placed on hold, off licensing and the player, until its artist says how it was made. That is the entire finding, and it is stated at that size on purpose.

Since the research note was written, the open SONICS model has also been scoring every upload. Its score is used as a prompt to listen, never as a verdict. About 6% of the catalogue's pre-2024 human-made tracks score above the 0.75 line the model treats as generated, so the score never holds, hides or labels anything on its own, and a reviewer's "heard it" mark overrules it.

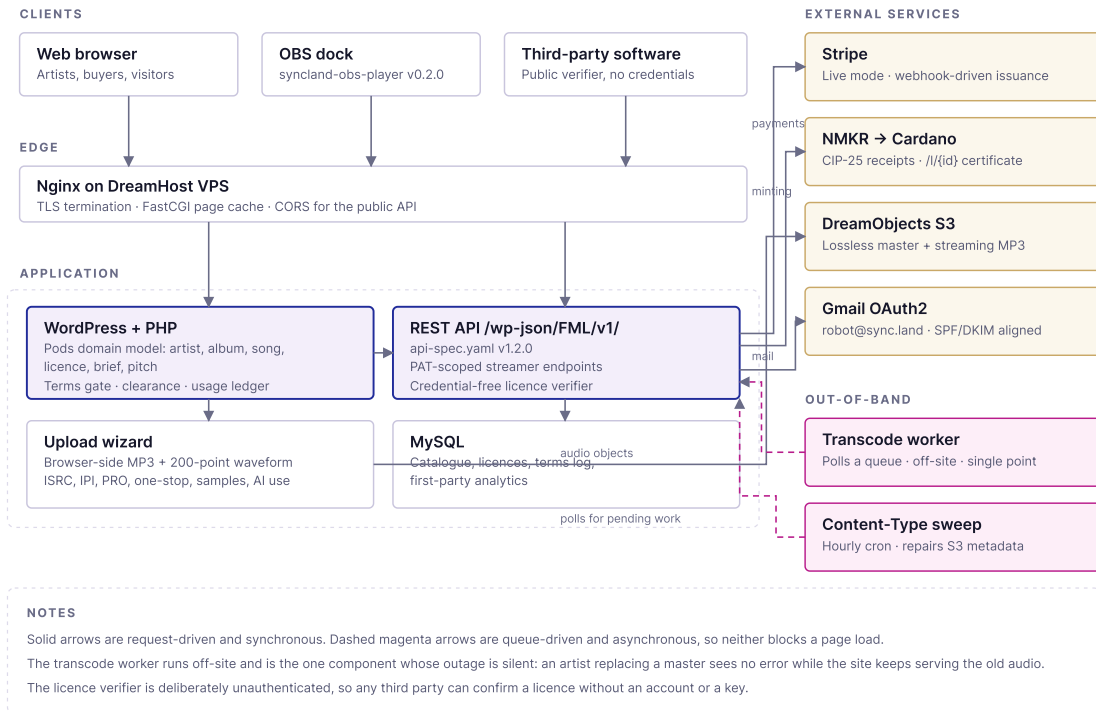
4 • Architecture

Sync.Land runs as a WordPress application with a Pods-modelled domain layer (artists, albums, songs, licences, briefs, pitches) on a DreamHost VPS behind Nginx with FastCGI caching. Audio lives in DreamHost DreamObjects S3-compatible storage: the lossless master and the streaming MP3 are stored side by side per track, the master being what a buyer receives and the MP3 what a visitor hears.

Payments run through Stripe in live mode, with webhook-driven licence issuance. On-chain minting goes through NMKR to Cardano using CIP-25. Transactional mail is sent as robot@sync.land through Gmail over OAuth2, which keeps DKIM and SPF aligned to the sending domain.

Two workloads sit outside the web tier. An hourly sweep repairs audio Content-Type metadata on S3 objects, and a polling transcode worker converts masters uploaded outside the browser wizard, probes every file for integrity and, since 18 September, reads its provenance metadata and reports both back to the site in one call. Both workloads are queue-driven, so the site stays responsive and neither blocks a request. Share-card

rendering and the provenance backfill run the same way, as queued jobs with a time budget, so that a catalogue of 900 posts can be re-rendered or re-read without anyone noticing. A queue of the same kind submits new and changed URLs to IndexNow every few minutes.



Sync.Land system topology at closeout

The diagram reads top to bottom by request path and left to right by dependency. Solid arrows are synchronous; dashed arrows are the two queue-driven workers, which is why neither can slow a page load and, in the transcode worker's case, why its outage is silent rather than loud.

5 • Metrics

All figures read from the production database on **2026-09-29** (21:41 site time, so "September" below means 1 to 29 September, and "the last thirty days" means 30 August to 29 September), except where a figure is marked with an earlier date. Any figure that changes before submission should be re-read, not adjusted by hand. The M4 pack's figures were read on its own submission date; where the two packs differ, the figure here is the later reading of the same query.

5.0 Activity across the reporting window

Activity across the Fund 11 reporting window

Every bar is one calendar month, from criteria approval (Feb 2024) to closeout (Sep 2026).



Read from production on 2026-09-29. The empty stretch from Oct 2024 to Feb 2026 is the schedule slip described in section 2.1, drawn to scale rather than cropped out.

Registered accounts, catalogue, briefs and pitches per month

Three things are visible here that the tables below cannot show.

- The catalogue arrives in bursts, not a trickle: a 116-song import in March 2026, then artist-driven uploads from June onward that reach 258 songs in September, more than twice the import.
- Briefs and pitches only exist from July 2026, because the board shipped during M4. Pitching followed within the month it launched, and September’s 164 pitches are more than four times the two previous months combined.
- Account growth is flat until August 2026, then turns sharply upward without any paid promotion. That inflection is the single most important shape in this report; sections 5.6 and 5.8 cover what caused it.

5.1 Catalogue and participation

MEASURE	AT CLOSEOUT
Registered users	150
Users holding the artist role	76
Published artist profiles	93
of which name a country	85
Artists with at least one published song	67
Published albums	192
Published songs	660
Open briefs	4
Countries and territories represented	26

Country spread: US (41), GB (7), NG (4), BR, CA and IT (3 each), AU, DE, NL and PT (2 each), then BE, CH, CO, FI, ID, IR, PA, PK, PS, PY, RO, RS, SK, TR, ZA and ZM with one artist each; eight profiles name no country. Counted by song rather than by artist, the largest countries are the United States (462), the Netherlands (56), the United Kingdom (28), Australia (26), Brazil (17), Nigeria (13) and Italy (12), and the largest genres are Rock (192), Hip-Hop/Rap (137), Pop (135), Electronic (132), Alternative/Indie (112), Blues (105), Folk (86), Soul (81), Cinematic (75) and Jazz (57).

The close-out video shows the same catalogue from the homepage, and its numbers are counted a little differently. It was recorded at about 18:40 site time on 29 September, three hours before this reading. The **653 tracks** it shows are the published songs at that moment; seven more were published before the reading, which makes 660. The **85 artists in 26 countries** is the footer of the homepage's "By country" view, which counts only the published artist profiles that name a country: all 93 profiles less the eight with none. It is not the number of artists with music, which is 67; a profile can be published before its first track. Nothing was added to either artist figure between the recording and the reading. The homepage's stats bar counts all 93 profiles as "independent artists".

The user count excludes one system holding account, which holds the licensed work of closed accounts and is not a person. Two further accounts, registered on 10 and 22 September, were deleted at their holders' request on 11 and 23 September under the closure procedure in section 3.5 and are not counted anywhere in this section.

5.2 Catalogue quality

Completeness of the metadata a buyer actually checks before licensing.

FIELD	SONGS CARRYING IT	SHARE OF 660
Lossless master	543	82%
Fully cleared (one-stop and samples clean)	386	58%
ISRC	390	59%
AI-use disclosure	460	70%

The AI-use disclosure field was added on 2026-08-25, so the songs without one are songs published before the field was asked, not artists declining to answer. All 258 songs published since it shipped carry a declaration: 239 declare no generated material and nineteen, from seven artists, declare generator assistance. A further 202 songs published before the field existed now carry one too. None declares fully generated audio. Two people who emailed in the final fortnight to ask whether generated work could be listed were told it could not, before either uploaded anything.

The provenance re-read described in section 3.6 adds one line to this table rather than changing it: of the 660 songs re-read by the date of issue, seven carry a generator's own stamp, six of them already declared, one from July listed for a human look. Nothing the file check found contradicts what an artist who was asked has said.

5.3 Licensing activity

MEASURE	AT CLOSEOUT
Project licences issued	14
to outside licensees (free tier, 2021 to 2023)	5
to the project itself (tests, demonstrations, its promotional videos)	9
paid for by an outside buyer	0
paid for by an outside buyer in the last thirty days	0
Stream licences, counted separately	2, both to the project's own artist account
Pitches submitted against briefs	201
On-chain receipts minted	4, and 4 submitted with minting pending

Fourteen licences is a small number and is stated as such, and most of them are the project's own. The five issued to outside licensees are free licences from 2021 to 2023, before the marketplace relaunched. The other nine were issued to the project, its administrator account or its own artist account: test purchases, the recorded demonstrations for M3 and M4, the three promotional videos in section 3.3, and on 29 September an on-chain licence test on a track from the Electronic pick. Stream licences, the per-track records the player creates on a first play, are counted on their own line and kept out of every other licence figure in this report; the two issued so far went to the project's own artist account on 29 September, the day the close-out video was recorded, and none has been issued outside testing.

The licensing infrastructure is complete and demonstrated end to end: checkout, PDF issuance, on-chain receipt and public verification all work in production and are evidenced in the M3 and M4 test-case recordings. What has not yet arrived is buyer demand. No third party has yet paid for a licence; the one Stripe payment in the analytics era was the project's own test purchase. In the last thirty days the licence dialog was opened 15 times and a song was added to the cart 3 times, and no outside buyer paid. That is a distribution problem rather than a build problem, and section 7 addresses it.

The 201 pitches, from 31 artists against 100 different briefs (289 briefs have been posted since the board shipped, four of them open on the date of reading), are the more informative number: they show artists actively working the marketplace rather than uploading and leaving. Of those, 164 were submitted in September. The close-out video quotes the reading of the evening before, 194 pitches from 29 artists; that is the total since the board opened in July, not a count for the last month alone. The board is also the platform's weakest promise so far: every one of the 201 pitches is still in its initial status, and no artist has yet received a decision on one. Section 7 puts closing that loop first.

5.4 Reach

MEASURE	AT CLOSEOUT
Recorded analytics events	28,932
Distinct sessions	2,231
Events since M3 (2026-06-23)	26,442
Events since M4 (2026-08-17)	20,570
Sessions in the last thirty days	1,452
of which opened from ChatGPT / Google	321 / 59

In the last thirty days ChatGPT was the largest identified source of sessions, as it has been since August; 967 of the 1,452 carry no source at all, which on this site means a typed address, a link from a message, an assistant that does not tag its links, or a crawler.

One caveat belongs beside this table. The acquisition audit in section 5.8 found that the page cache had been handing the same analytics session identifier to successive visitors, so that 64 "sessions" carrying 22% of all events are in fact several people each. Session counts here are therefore upper bounds on activity and lower bounds on people; the audit's own figures use visitors rather than sessions for that reason, and the identifier is being moved to the browser.

5.5 Consent and audit trail

The terms log holds **150 users**, one record each. **109 carry a timestamped signature** written by the gate itself: 5 real users who accepted the 2026-07-10 Terms through the on-site overlay on the day it went live, 19 who accepted that same version at registration (one of them recorded by a backfill of a registration the capture hook had missed), and 85 who accepted the 2026-09-08 Terms at registration. The remaining **41 are legacy accounts relabelled** to a 2024-01-01 version when the versioned gate was introduced, with no timestamp, address or source, because none was ever captured.

This report restates the figure deliberately. The M4 pack expressed it four different ways, two of which were wrong, and a closeout that quietly carried a different number again would leave a reviewer unable to tell which is true. The split above is the one verified against production, and it is the one to rely on.

5.6 Adoption signals

MONTH	SIGNUPS
2026-09	95 (to 29 September)
2026-08	8
2026-07	1
2026-06	1
2026-05	1

The August-September rise is entirely organic: no paid promotion ran at any point in the project. Artists found the platform through search, through a large language model recommending it, and through direct referral, then registered without prompting. Several wrote in unprompted to ask how to get their catalogues on.

The source is measurable, because the analytics attach the referring site to the first event of a visitor's session. Of the 95 accounts created in September, **48 arrived from ChatGPT**, 12 from Google search, one from Brave search, one from a link in a Gmail message, one from the briefs teaser on the site itself, four have no recorded events at all (unconfirmed registrations), and 28 have no recorded source, which on this site means a typed address, a link opened from a message, or an assistant that does not tag its links. A language model is now the largest single source of new artists, four times Google. Across every September session, not only those that registered, ChatGPT is the referrer on 319 of the 1,436, against 59 from Google. Of September's registrants, 73% made a profile, 71% of those profiles published a track, and 57% of those artists pitched a brief.

That shift, from one signup a month to 103 between 1 August and 29 September, without spend, is the clearest evidence in this report that the product answers a real need.

The signups are also turning into catalogue. The week between the 12 September reading and the 19 September one saw 61 songs published, and most of them came from people who did not exist on the platform a fortnight earlier: a production-music library in Australia, referred by ChatGPT, published thirteen single-track albums and pitched eight briefs in its first three days; a singer in the United States published nineteen tracks across two albums and pitched five briefs inside 96 minutes on her first evening; a publisher in Italy, arriving from a Google search that landed on the briefs board, published six releases and pitched two briefs within 68 minutes of registering; and nine more new artists published between one and six tracks each, three of them pitching briefs the same day. On the evening of 16 September an artist who had published fifteen albums in the first week of the month went back through them from the dashboard and repriced fourteen to \$100 for commercial use, with the free tier on across all fifteen. That is the first time an artist has used the licence controls across a whole catalogue rather than on a single track. The five days to 24 September added 46 more songs, net of removals: an artist in the Netherlands published sixteen tracks across two albums, every one with a lossless master; a management company in the United Kingdom set up two artist profiles and published four releases on its first day; and the Australian library added seven more tracks. The four days to 28 September added 83 songs

more: forty from the artist in the Netherlands, and first-day releases and pitches from new artists in Portugal and Slovakia. The last day before issue added sixteen more, fourteen of them from artists who had registered in the previous six days.

5.7 Four journeys from the final weeks

Signup counts say how many arrived. Three people who arrived in the same forty-eight hours show what happened next, and each took a different path. A fourth, twelve days later, arrived as a streamer rather than an artist.

NINETEEN MINUTES, NO EMAIL

A singer-songwriter found the site through a Google search on the evening of 10 September, registered at 21:27, built a profile with a photo and a bio by 21:30, and had a one-track album published, with a WAV that the transcoder converted on its next pass, by 21:46. No support, no one from the project in the loop. That is the journey the platform was built for, and the first time it happened on its own.

TIME	STEP
21:27	Registered (Google search, homepage)
21:30	Artist profile with photo and bio
21:46	One-track album published, WAV queued
next pass	MP3, duration and waveform generated by the worker

FAILED TWICE, RESCUED TWICE

A Los Angeles artist manager uploading her first track hit the image optimiser's resizer on a 3000-pixel PNG: 121 seconds where the stock resizer takes 1.5, the request killed at 120, nothing logged. She tried twice and wrote in. The trace built that afternoon found the stage; she retried ten minutes after the fix went live and pitched four briefs within five minutes. The second failure was hers, and equally invisible: the file she chose was the 4 KB macOS sidecar that Windows shows beside a Mac-copied WAV. The site accepted it, published the album, and the worker retried it every five minutes all night. Both gaps are closed: image work no longer runs inside the request the artist is waiting on, and a file under 200 KB or named `._*` is refused with an explanation of which file to pick. She replaced the file the same evening and has since pitched a fifth brief.

TURNED AWAY BY POLICY

A songwriter from Portland, referred by a language model, registered in the morning, came back in the evening, built a profile with a Spotify link, opened the uploader for eight minutes, and then went looking for the company behind the site to ask how to close his account. His reason, in his own words the next morning:

I am a songwriter. I have been writing lyrics for years. I use suno to bring it to life. Your site does not allow it. If this is the case, close the account please.

He was right. The policy adopted on 8 September (Terms, section 11 of the Free Sync License, the uploader, the FAQ) is that audio produced entirely by a generator has no copyright owner and therefore nothing to license, however human the lyrics on it. He is the first person that policy has cost the platform. He was told plainly, his

account was closed the same day under the closure procedure written that week, and the door was left open for a version he performs himself. A marketplace that sells licences has to decline work it cannot license, and it has to be able to say so in two sentences.

EASY TO INSTALL, SILENT ON THE DAY

The first outside streamer, who streams on Twitch, signed up on 22 September, installed the OBS player in a few minutes and said setup was easy. On his stream day nothing played. The server logs showed why. His access key had been entered in his desktop browser, and OBS keeps its own browser storage, so the player inside OBS had never seen it; and the player had been added as a Source rather than a dock. It sat in demo mode for the whole stream, and nothing reached his audience.

Within two days the setup was rebuilt around that evening, as section 3.4 describes: one page at `sync.land/stream` that makes a player link with the key built in, two pastes in OBS, a live “Player connected” tick, and a player that says where it belongs when it is opened in the wrong place.

WHEN	STEP
22 September	Signed up, installed the player, called setup easy
Stream day	Key in the desktop browser, player added as a Source: demo mode, nothing played
Two days later	<code>sync.land/stream</code> live: key in the link, two pastes, connected tick, self-explaining player
Five days later	Ready-made playlists and picks on <code>/stream</code> , a licence on each track’s first play, the free licence extended to live streams

He also said he could not see how to make a playlist of his own, which is why the player now starts from ready-made playlists rather than an empty list. He had not played through the Dock again by the date of issue.

WHAT THE FOUR HAVE IN COMMON

Two of the first three needed something the Terms promised and the site could not do on its own: close an account. The fourth needed the player to say where it belonged. Those gaps and the sidecar file were found by real people rather than by testing, which is the argument for keeping the upload trace and the inbox open after the grant ends. The inbox has since paid for itself again: on 15 September a songwriter emailed to ask how to get a track on, was pointed at the uploader, and had it registered, uploaded and live within two hours of the reply, nineteen minutes of that on the site.

5.8 Where artists come from, and where they stop

An acquisition and funnel audit was run against production on 17 September and is published with this report (`acquisition-audit-2026-09.md`). It reads the analytics table, the user and post tables, the survey and eight days of web-server logs; no third-party analytics product is connected.

46%

of accounts since 1 June first arrived via a ChatGPT link (23 of 50)

38% vs 10%

registration rate for ChatGPT visitors landing on About versus the homepage

75 / 67 / 55

per cent of September registrants who made a profile, of profiles that uploaded, of uploaders who pitched

48 of 50

registrants since June are musicians; no buyer side has arrived yet

Six findings matter for what comes next.

FINDING	THE EVIDENCE	WHAT IT IMPLIES
ChatGPT is the largest identifiable source of new artists, and it is compounding.	New ChatGPT-referred visitors per week went 3, 4, 8, 5, 15, 13, 8, 31, 40; their share of new visitors went from 7% in June to 28% in September. One in five bounces, against four in five for untagged traffic, most of which is crawlers.	The channel is worth serving deliberately. Roadmap items 1 and 2.
Where a visitor lands matters more than where they came from.	ChatGPT visitors landing on the homepage registered at 10%; on About, 38%. Yet the fetch ChatGPT makes while composing an answer read the homepage 248 times in eight days and About four times.	The facts that convert (free to list, non-exclusive, open briefs) belong on the page the assistant reads.
The funnel is fast at the top and leaks at the uploader.	Median six minutes from registration to a profile, 39 to a first track. Of twelve profiles with no track, seven opened the uploader, one four times, none submitted, no error fired.	The drops are decisions. The wizard's demand for an album, cover art and a lossless file up front is the most likely reason. Roadmap item 3.
Google is small and mostly brand.	Half of Google landings are the homepage from a search for the site's own name. Google registrations track the ChatGPT curve a step behind.	Search is verifying a recommendation made elsewhere, not making one.
There is no buyer side yet.	Four anonymous visitors added a song to the cart and stopped at the login wall. No song has more than three plays from sessions other than its owner's.	Guest checkout and a pitch loop before any buyer outreach. Roadmap items 1 and 6.
The measurement itself had a defect.	The session identifier was served from the page cache, so one identifier was shared by up to 42 browsers.	The audit worked at visitor level. Session figures are not quoted until the identifier is minted in the browser; section 5.4 says so.

The audit's ranked recommendations are folded into section 7.

6 • Lessons Learned

Most of what this project learned arrived as an incident: a real person hit something, wrote in or walked away, and the trail explained why. The table records those incidents in one place, what the person saw, why the platform did not see it, and what runs differently now. The principles that follow are what the incidents have in common.

6.1 What people hit, and what changed

WHAT THE PERSON SAW	WHY THE PLATFORM DID NOT SEE IT	WHAT RUNS DIFFERENTLY NOW
June: the signup form would not submit. Nothing on the page said why.	HTML5 <code>required</code> sat on every checkbox in a role group; ticking one left seven unsatisfied, and the inputs were styled invisible, so the browser anchored its complaint to nothing. A script normally stripped the attribute; anyone whose scripts lost that race failed silently.	Attribute removed at source on 13 June. The lasting change is in how drop-offs are read: a person who cannot submit a signup form never appears in a funnel, so a quiet funnel is checked before it is believed.
A legitimate artist on a mobile network outside Europe and North America was refused at registration.	reCAPTCHA v3 scores on network and browsing history with no way to prove otherwise.	Replaced with Cloudflare Turnstile, which lets a person prove themselves rather than scoring them in the background.
2 September: an artist read three licensing tiers, wanted the third, found it could not be bought, and declined to upload his catalogue.	The page advertised three routes and the upload wizard offered two. Nothing failed, so nothing logged.	SLCS-v1.0 names the reserved uses as things an artist is asked about rather than sold. The fix he pointed to, a Custom opt-in at upload and a request flow, is roadmap item 4 and is not built.
An artist replaced a master; the site kept playing the old audio with no error.	The transcode worker runs on one laptop. When it is off, its absence is invisible to monitoring and audible only to the artist.	The worker's own status page shows its last poll, current job and every verdict; a second host and an on-site alarm are roadmap work.
10 September: an artist manager's first upload spun, then showed an empty page. Twice.	The image plugin's resizer took 121 seconds on a 3000-pixel PNG where the stock resizer takes 1.5; PHP-FPM killed the request at 120 seconds and logged nothing.	Override off, image work moved out of the request the artist waits on, every upload stage traced to the PHP log. She retried ten minutes after the fix and pitched four briefs.
The same artist's album published with a track that existed and did not play.	The file was a 4 KB macOS <code>. _</code> sidecar. It was a file, it had the right name, it uploaded; validation had checked that an upload happened, not that the result was music.	Sidecars and files under 200 KB refused with a note on which file to pick; every file probed before it goes live and held in a file-check state if it fails; the worker gives up after five failures.
13 September: an artist in Nigeria restored a saved draft, pressed Submit Release, and was returned to step one four times without a word.	The handler re-validates every step and jumps to the first failure; cover art is the one field a browser cannot restore from a draft, and the browser's own message cannot point at a field on a step that was just hidden.	A failing step shows a banner naming the field; a restored draft with no cover art lands on step one with the reason.
An artist asked whether "Expired" against his pitches meant he had been rejected.	The label carried the system's meaning (the brief's window closed without a decision), not the reader's.	The label now reads "Brief closed", the pitches page says in one line that a closed window is not a rejection, and the help centre answers the same question.
The genre "R&B/Soul" read as "R&B/Soul"; a chosen country filter turned the same pink as its button; every artist photo looked soft.	Each was a small defect that only shows under real use: double encoding, a missing selected-state colour, a 300-pixel image in a 320-pixel card. None was found by a test.	All three fixed the day they were seen. Each was found by reading the live site the way a visitor does, after the catalogue had grown past the point where anyone had seen every entry.

WHAT THE PERSON SAW	WHY THE PLATFORM DID NOT SEE IT	WHAT RUNS DIFFERENTLY NOW
17 September: session counts on the dashboard were plausible and wrong.	The analytics session identifier was inlined into cached pages, so up to 42 browsers shared one identifier for months.	Audit worked at visitor level; the identifier will be minted in the browser instead. Section 5.4 marks the affected figures.
18 September: a track sounded generated to a human ear; nothing on the platform could say more.	The strongest evidence of generated audio, a plain-text stamp a generator writes into its own WAV exports, sat in a comment field next to the one the platform had been reading for a month.	Every metadata chunk of every file is now read; a file that names a generator goes to a human review table. Every statistical heuristic tested on the catalogue's own files separated nothing, and the research note publishes those numbers.
22 September: the first outside streamer installed the OBS player in minutes and called setup easy. On his stream day nothing played.	His key had been entered in his desktop browser, and OBS keeps its own browser storage; the player had also been added as a Source rather than a dock. It sat in demo mode, and only the server logs showed it.	Rebuilt in two days: <code>sync.land/stream</code> makes a player link with the key built in (after the <code>#</code> , so it never reaches a server log), two pastes in OBS, a live "Player connected" tick. The player says "This link goes in OBS, not your browser" in a normal browser, shows its status inside OBS, and covers itself with instructions if added as a Source. Ready-made playlists, picks and a licence on each first play followed on 27 September.
24 September: two artists got a bare "Error: Upload failed" on every try, in two browsers, with WAV and MP3 alike.	The storage host's firewall refused a filename containing an apostrophe, and any character outside plain ASCII returned a server error; the wizard reported neither.	Filenames are cleaned in the browser before upload, with the typed title untouched; a failed upload says what happened and is recorded as an event.
28 September: an artist on a slow connection pressed Submit Release four times and got a browser timeout each time, and the saved draft was gone after each try.	The request never reached the server, so nothing was logged anywhere; the wizard had cleared the draft the moment Submit was pressed.	The draft is kept until the server confirms the release and, since 29 September, is also saved to the artist's account; a reachability check runs first, and every attempt is recorded with its size and connection figures. Uploading the cover image in the background, before submit, is roadmap item 3.

6.2 What the incidents have in common

SILENT FAILURE IS THE EXPENSIVE KIND

More than half of the fourteen incidents produced no error, no log line and no event. The cost was paid by the person least able to report it, and only surfaced when one of them took the trouble to write. A defect that refuses loudly is cheap; one that publishes, or turns someone away without a word, is not.

A FILE, A FORM OR A CLAIM IS NOT ACCEPTED UNTIL IT IS CHECKED

The sidecar, the third tier and the on-chain receipt were all accepted by the platform and useless to the person relying on them. Verify against the system that has to honour the thing, the decoder, the checkout, the rights desk, not against the fact that it arrived.

DEMAND RECRUITS SUPPLY

Of 95 September registrants, 30 were on the briefs board within five minutes and 55 reached it eventually. Artists arrive for briefs, not for the catalogue. A board that recruits this well and answers nobody spends trust it has not earned, which is why the pitch loop is roadmap item 1.

A LICENCE HAS TO HOLD UP WHERE THE CLAIM IS MADE

Research in the final week on YouTube Content ID and Meta's Rights Manager found that the risk to a licensee is rarely the first automated claim, which a real licence usually wins on dispute. It is the escalation that follows when the claimant, usually the artist's distributor, has no record of the licence. The platform cannot switch a claim system off for a track it does not own; it can make the licence easy to prove and bring the artist in early.

THE PAGE AN ASSISTANT READS IS THE PAGE THAT NEEDS THE FACTS

ChatGPT fetched the homepage sixty times for every fetch of the page that converts. Plain, server-rendered facts on the landing page matter more to this channel than any amount of structured data elsewhere.

DROPS ARE DECISIONS UNLESS THE LOG SAYS OTHERWISE

Twelve profiles with no track looked like a bug. Seven had opened the uploader, some repeatedly, and closed it with no error. A form that asks for an album, cover art and a lossless master before it accepts one demo is not broken; it asks too much, too early, of someone with one song.

MEASURE, THEN TRUST THE MEASUREMENT ONLY AFTER CHECKING IT

Session counts were wrong for months because they were plausible. Figures went stale between writing and review, always upward. Dating every number and re-reading production rather than adjusting by hand is the only version that stays honest.

READ THE CATALYST DASHBOARD CAREFULLY

Criteria approval is shown in the same place as deliverable acceptance, and twice the two were conflated, once recording a milestone as complete when its evidence had not been submitted. Confirm deliverable state separately.

EVIDENCE IS A DELIVERABLE

Each milestone pack ran to five to seven documents plus recordings and took closer to a week than an afternoon. One Markdown source per document, one template and one script that regenerates every PDF paid for itself by the second milestone.

A SINGLE-FOUNDER PROJECT SPENDS ITS SLIPPAGE ON THE UNGLAMOROUS HALF

The 271 days past target went largely on work with no demo: security fixes, consent and audit infrastructure, mail deliverability, and correcting claims that turned out to be wrong. None of it is in a feature list, and skipping it would have produced a demo that could not have been handed to a real artist.

7 • Roadmap Beyond Fund 11

The platform continues past Fund 11 as an operating service. Eight things are scoped, in the order they are worth doing. Each is drawn from sections 5 and 6 and from the acquisition audit's ranked recommendations, and each states what is and is not built.

#	ITEM	WHY, IN EVIDENCE	WHAT IT IS, AND WHAT EXISTS TODAY
1	Close the pitch loop, then the brief-to-pitch gap	Thirty of September's 95 signups were on the briefs board within five minutes of registering or came from it. All 201 pitches are in their initial status; no artist has received a decision.	A received state with a stated review window, a weekly digest of new pitches per brief, and a reviewed, shortlisted or not-this-time status the artist sees and is emailed. Then let a pitch precede a full upload and make a brief a landing destination. No new infrastructure. Not built.
2	Put the facts an assistant needs where it reads them	ChatGPT composes its recommendation from the homepage, which above the fold is two sentences and a genre list; the page that converts is About.	A plain server-rendered block on the homepage: what the site is, what it costs an artist, what a licensee gets, who runs it, with the same figures on About, Licensing and the machine-readable summary; then an artists page written as questions and answers with FAQ structured data. Built since the audit: <code>/llms.txt</code> and <code>/llms-full.txt</code> from live counts, corrected song structured data, crawlable links to every song and artist, sitemap hygiene and IndexNow. Not built: the homepage block and the artists page.
3	Lower the first-track threshold	At the audit on 17 September, twelve of thirty September profiles had never uploaded, seven after opening the wizard and leaving with no error; seven of thirteen abandoned profiles stopped on the image.	Accept one track with an MP3 and no cover art, defer the album fields, state the requirements before the form, make the profile image optional, and upload the cover image in the background while the artist fills in the rest, so a slow connection does not carry the whole release in one request at submit. Built: the first-track nudge template; rights, tags and PRO asked once per release; one closing checkbox; a draft kept until the server confirms; submit diagnostics. Not built: the single-track path and the background cover upload.
4	Resolve the third licensing tier	A tier that is advertised and cannot be bought has already cost the platform a catalogue. The artist it cost was explicit that he wanted control over larger uses, not larger fees.	A Custom opt-in at upload, where an artist marks a track as open to larger uses by request only, and a request flow on the song page that routes those requests to the artist. Built: SLCS-v1.0 names the reserved uses. Not built: the opt-in and the request flow.
5	Move the transcode worker onto real infrastructure	The one remaining single point of failure, and the only one whose outage is invisible to both monitoring and the artist. It now also carries the integrity and provenance checks.	Host it properly, or at least alarm on queue age (a day's work). Built: the worker's own status page. Not built: hosting, alarm, second host.

#	ITEM	WHY, IN EVIDENCE	WHAT IT IS, AND WHAT EXISTS TODAY
6	Buyer-side distribution	Supply arrives unprompted; demand does not, and no third party has yet paid for a licence. Four anonymous visitors reached the cart and met a login wall.	First: guest checkout, and a search console so the site can see the queries it is found for. The three promotional videos in section 3.3, one per buyer segment, are drafted and not yet published. Then the differentiated route: the credential-free verification API and the agent-facing direction in section 3.4, machine-to-machine clearance priced for a twelve-second use, rather than competing with established libraries on catalogue size. Nothing in that direction is built.
7	Grow streamers as the second funnel	The first outside streamer installed the player easily and still played nothing on his stream day; the fix took two days once the logs showed why. A connected streamer plays the catalogue to an audience every time they go live.	Built: <code>sync.land/stream</code> , the self-explaining player, the For Streamers menu entry, homepage band and help topic, SLFS-v1.2 for live streams, a licence on each first play, saved playlists and picks. Next, from the project's streamer acquisition research (September 2026): mark stream-ready playlists as picks, record a three-minute setup video, and recruit ten small streamers one at a time, each message approved before it is sent. Specified and waiting on approval: a streamer email journey. Not built: sending it.
8	A claim desk for licensees	A licensee who is claimed on YouTube or Meta usually wins the first dispute with a licence; the danger is an appeal against a distributor that has never seen it. Nothing on the platform helps with that today beyond the public verifier.	Channel verification on each licence (a read-only YouTube or Twitch sign-in, so the licence names the exact channel), a dispute kit built on the public verifier (licence text, verified channel, the play record from the usage ledger, ready-to-paste dispute text), and "Report a claim" in the Dock, which starts the kit and brings the artist in. SLFS-v1.2 already promises the licence and play record on request. Not built.

Two things are deliberately not on the list. Paid promotion, because the organic channel is compounding and its content is not yet right. And an automatic AI-music classifier, because the research note found nothing that would be accurate enough to act on. The open SONICS model does score every upload, but only as a prompt for a person to listen: about 6% of the catalogue's pre-2024 human-made tracks score above its 0.75 line, so it never triggers a hold on its own and a reviewer's "heard it" mark overrules it.

8 · Financial Summary

MILESTONE	SHARE	ADA	STATUS
M1 Initialization	20%	20,000	Approved 2024-04-22
M2 Development	25%	25,000	Approved 2024-07-18
M3 Marketplace	20%	20,000	Approved 2026-08-19
M4 Marketplace Updates & API	20%	20,000	Approved 2026-09-10
M5 Finalization	15%	15,000	This submission
Total	100%	100,000	

8.1 Disbursements received on chain

Catalyst pays each milestone's schedule after the previous milestone's Proof of Achievement is approved. Every payment to this project was sent to the project wallet at the ADA handle `$awen` (`addr1q9mcsgapzarg96n7cdt0m0l04jcr8lsypdh4jupcfg7u0tsuczyl9mps9cj5afffaudy6qk9hr7lts46xtqyrf77napspteyvp`) from the Catalyst treasury address `addr1q8q7jyap76l0d5gqj8n...`, in batch transactions carrying the on-chain message "Description: Fund11 Cohort". A batch settles several projects in one transaction; Awen has two Fund 11 projects with identical M1 and M2 schedules, so the 2024 batches carry two matching outputs and the Sync.Land amount is stated per transaction rather than per output. The Milestone Module shows 85,000 ADA distributed, and the six transactions below reconcile to it exactly.

DATE (UTC)	SCHEDULE ITEM	ADA TO <code>\$AWEN</code>	TRANSACTION
2024-03-15	M1 initial payment (80%)	16,000	97fc940a...6a41ba0
2024-05-16	M2 month 1: remaining 20% of M1 (4,000) plus 10,000	14,000	c1d89a67...869b1ce
2024-06-11	M2 month 2	10,000	8b5f9033...2d814913
2026-08-13	M3 schedule in full: remaining 20% of M2 (5,000) plus 17 monthly instalments of 941.18	21,000	8e943f2e...04cb2ab6
2026-08-27	M4 schedule: remaining 20% of M3 (4,000) plus 16,000	20,000	7cf9ac93...d1dbe0be
2026-09-17	Remaining 20% of M4	4,000	ae279bc3...280f5e05
	Received to date	85,000	
	M5 closeout payment, released on approval of this submission	15,000	
	Project total	100,000	

The 15 March 2024 batch is one of two that day carrying a 16,000 output to `$awen`; the other, `1e1c3200...8da8deb2`, is the sister project's initial payment. The M3 schedule was released as a single payment on 13 August 2026 rather than as the seventeen monthly instalments the plan lists.

9 · Closing Statement

In early 2024 the Cardano community funded a bet: that an independent musician, with no publisher and no catalogue deal, could put a song in front of the people who license music for film, games and streams, and be paid for it, with the proof of that transaction living on a public chain rather than in someone's filing cabinet. Two and a half years later the bet has a website, and the website has a public.

What was promised was built, and it is not a prototype. Every one of the five milestones has published artefacts behind every acceptance criterion. The platform takes real money through Stripe, issues real licences with a public verifier that needs no account, mints CIP-25 receipts on Cardano, exposes a REST API that a streamer's OBS player already consumes, and runs a briefs board where requests from music supervisors are posted and artists pitch. 660 songs, 93 artists, twenty-six countries. The code and the documentation are open.

What was not promised, and matters more, is that people found it on their own. No advertising ran at any point in the project. Artists arrived from a search engine, from a language model that decided to recommend the site, and from each other: one signup a month through the spring, then 95 in the first twenty-nine days of September. They did not just register. They built profiles in six minutes, uploaded in the same sitting, and pitched briefs the same day. A production-music library in Australia, a film composer in Bologna, a singer in Port Elizabeth, a touring guitarist of forty years in the United States: none of them was asked to come. That is the evidence the project set out to find, and it is the reason the platform continues after this report.

The project is also honest about where it stands. Fourteen licences exist and none of them was bought by a stranger. The marketplace has one side, and section 7 is written from that fact rather than around it. Five things in the proposal came out differently on contact with the world, and section 2 names each. The schedule slipped by 271 days, spent largely on work with no demo: security, consent, audit trails, and the answer to a question the proposal did not know to ask in 2024, which is what a licensing marketplace does about generated audio. Sync.Land now has a policy, a disclosure every buyer can see, and a provenance check that puts the few files that name a generator in front of a person. The research behind it, including everything that did not work, is published so that the next team does not repeat it.

Public money bought a public good: a working piece of infrastructure, an open record of how it was built and what it cost, a body of evidence about how independent artists actually behave when offered a fair deal, and a set of hard-won lessons written down plainly enough to be reused. It also bought a year of listening to musicians, who broke things, wrote in, explained why they left, and in doing so made the platform better than any plan would have. The grant ends here. The work does not.